



For CXOs, engaging young minds forces them to challenge assumptions and stay up to date on emerging technologies

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BOARDROOM'S CLASS ACT

B-SCHOOLS ARE INCREASINGLY ENGAGING WITH INDUSTRY EXECUTIVES TO GIVE THEIR STUDENTS A TASTE OF THE WORLD BEYOND CLASSROOMS

BY K. GIRIPRAKASH

INDIA'S BUSINESS SCHOOLS are reshaping classrooms. This time, the change is not being driven by new syllabi, case studies, or international tie-ups, but by something more fundamental: the presence of industry leaders themselves. For years, India's management

schools have received accolades for their academic rigour but also faced criticism for being too theoretical. That theoretical-practical divide is now rapidly closing.

"Management education needs to be relevant to real-world practices," says Mukta Kulkarni, Director of Programs at IIM Bangalore. "We

proactively invite industry leaders (across renewable energy, biotech, fintech, AI and machine learning, aerospace, EV, cybersecurity, space technology) in our classrooms."

Kulkarni says this creates a more engaging learning environment and a more direct connection between academia and the workplace. Students